

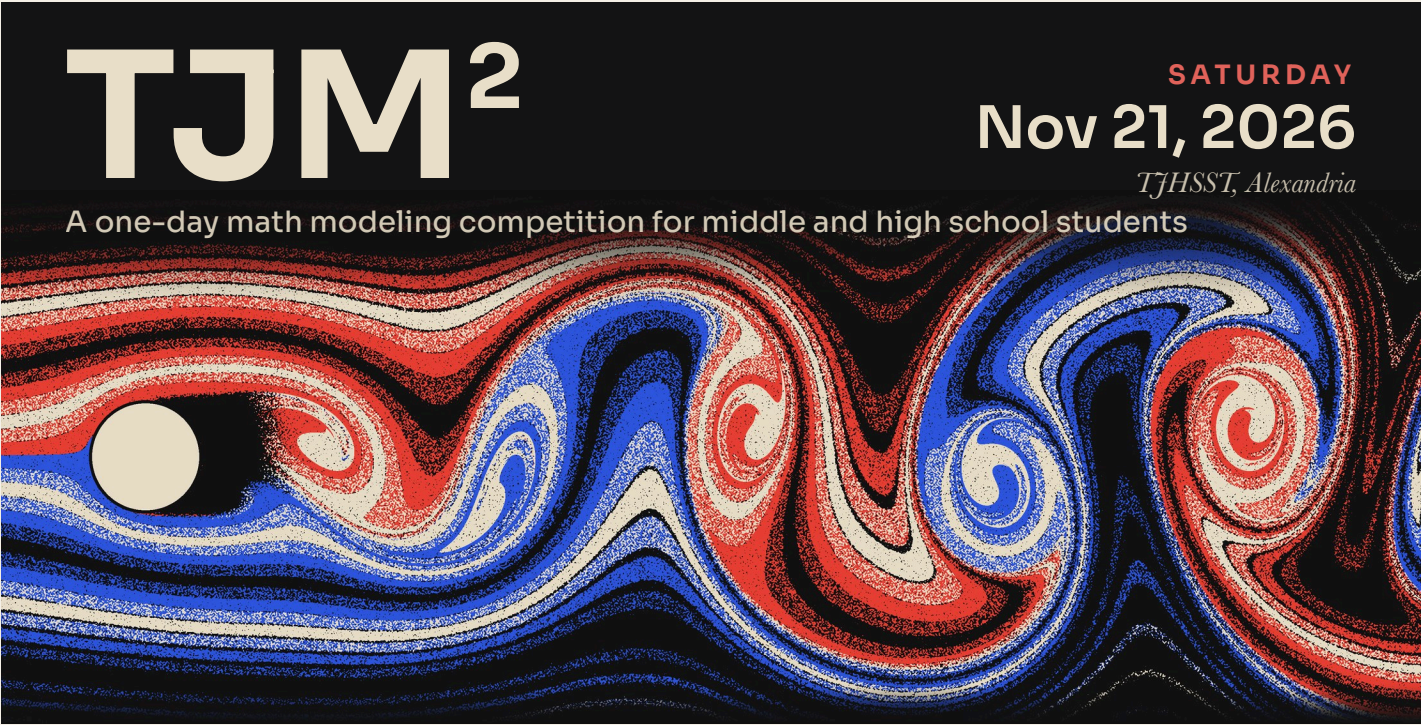


Fig 1 Will Northern Virginia’s data centers outgrow the power grid?
Sample The real problem is revealed at 9 a.m. on competition day.

1 day <i>8 a.m. to 7 p.m.</i>	6–12 <i>grades, two divisions</i>	3–5 <i>per team, or come solo</i>	\$2,000+ <i>in prizes</i>	Free <i>food included</i>
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HOW IT WORKS

- 1 Get the problem.**
Open-ended, built on real data, with no single right answer.
- 2 Build a model with your team.**
Math, code, spreadsheets: whatever works. Papers are due mid-afternoon.
- 3 Defend it.**
Finalists present to judges; awards and raffles close the night.

AI policy. Use AI to find models and write code. Judges score how well you can justify every decision.

WHY COME

- **\$2,000+ in prizes**, swag for every team that turns in a paper, and raffles.
- **A day out with friends**, with free lunch, dinner and snacks.
- **No experience needed.** We teach the basics that morning and answer questions on our Discord.
- **TJ students:** top performers are considered for our M3 Challenge team.

SCHEDULE

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|--------------|--------------------------|
| 8:00 | Check-in, breakfast |
| 8:45 | Opening ceremony |
| 9:00 | Problem released |
| 12:00 | Lunch |
| 3:00 | Papers due |
| 3:15 | Games while judges read |
| 4:45 | Finalist presentations |
| 6:15 | Dinner |
| 6:30 | Awards and raffle |

Tentative; details by email.

SAMPLE PROBLEM
Not this year’s

Northern Virginia is the world’s largest data-center market, and Dominion Energy projects its Virginia electricity load could roughly double within 15 years. **(1)** Model a data center’s power draw across a year. **(2)** Forecast the region’s demand 5–15 years out. Will it outgrow supply? Quantify your uncertainty. **(3)** Recommend where the next ones should go.

Data provided: EIA Form 861 · PJM load forecasts · Dominion’s Integrated Resource Plan · JLARC data-center study (2024) · Loudoun County GeoHub. See a winning paper: [TJ’s 2023 M3 Challenge champion](#).